INDEPENDENT COMPETITIVE INTELLIGENCE WORK SAMPLE

Conversational AI in Life Sciences

Competitive landscape and implications for Optum Life Sciences

RWE | Commercial Intelligence | Medical / Regulatory Research | Clinical Trials | Market Access

Outside-in assessment of publicly marketed conversational AI across five Optum LS-relevant business domains

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Conversational AI is being marketed across life sciences workflows, creating new ways to access information, analytics and decision support

OUTSIDE-IN RESEARCH LENS

This study is an assessment of *publicly-marketed* conversational AI products across five Optum Life Sciences-relevant business domains:

RWE | Commercial Intelligence | Medical / Regulatory Research | Clinical Trials and Market Access

The U.S. is the primary competitive focus; selected international offerings provide context; Optum LS anchors the comparisons.

KEY FINDINGS

19 The U.S. screen identified **19 conversational AI offerings** across five business domains, **concentrated in RWE and Commercial Intelligence**.

9 **Nine selected international offerings** show how vendors outside the U.S. position conversational interaction, concentrated in **RWE and Commercial Intelligence**.

OPTUM LS POSITIONING

Optum LS publicly emphasizes linked healthcare data, AI-enabled research tools and scientific expertise.

Several competitors prominently market conversational interfaces as the entry point to comparable customer tasks.

This reflects differences in public positioning, not necessarily in underlying functionality.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION

The competitive significance of conversational AI depends on the customer task, underlying data and reliability of the results.

Where could conversational interaction add value to Optum LS's existing offerings?

RESEARCH CATALYST

Recent product launches in RWE prompted a broader examination of conversational AI across life sciences

SELECTED PUBLIC PRODUCT ANNOUNCEMENTS

2024

Earlier precedents

Tempus's **Tempus One / Lens** — AI-assisted research and cohort exploration (February)

Komodo Health's **MapAI** — conversational healthcare analytics (September)

August 2025

Platform expansion

Komodo Health's **Marmot** — AI-powered healthcare analytics and research workflows

April–May 2026

Research-interface launches

Truveta's **Truveta Intelligence** — natural-language RWE research questions

Flatiron Health's **Telescope** — conversational oncology cohort exploration

September 2026

New releases

Verana Health's **Agent Claire** — conversational specialty-data research

Norstella's **Atlas Patient Analytics** — agentic, managed cohort analytics

THE BROADER COMPETITIVE QUESTION

Where else are life sciences vendors marketing conversational AI, what tasks does it serve, and how does that positioning compare with Optum LS?

OUR RESEARCH RESPONSE

We examine publicly marketed conversational AI across five Optum LS-relevant business domains. Vendors' product claims provide observable evidence for competitive positioning without access to internal product data.

Among U.S. competitors, conversational AI is most prominent in RWE; Optum LS has relevant offerings in all five domains

43 U.S. competitors screened → **15** distinct competitors marketing conversational AI

Competitors marketing conversational AI / Total comparable competitors	Domain	Conversational AI offerings	Relevant Optum LS offerings
9 / 34	**RWE**	Komodo Health's Marmot and MapAI; Truveta's Truveta Intelligence; Flatiron Health's Telescope; Tempus's Lens; and more	Analytics on Demand; epidemiology research
3 / 23	**Commercial Intelligence**	IQVIA's Field Force Agent and GMI Agent; ZS's Conversational AI for Commercial; Trinity's InsightsEDGE Digital Twins	Market Clarity: portfolio and patient/prescriber analytics
3 / 18	**Medical / Regulatory Research**	IQVIA's Med-R1; ZS's Conversational AI for Medical; Veeva's Vault AI Chat	Postapproval safety studies; Market Clarity medical affairs insights
1 / 25	**Clinical Trials**	TriNetX's LIVE Conversational AI + Terrain	Prospector; Digital Research Network; True Source
1 / 24	**Market Access**	EVERSANA's Ask NAVLIN	HEOR/value evidence; Evidence Engine

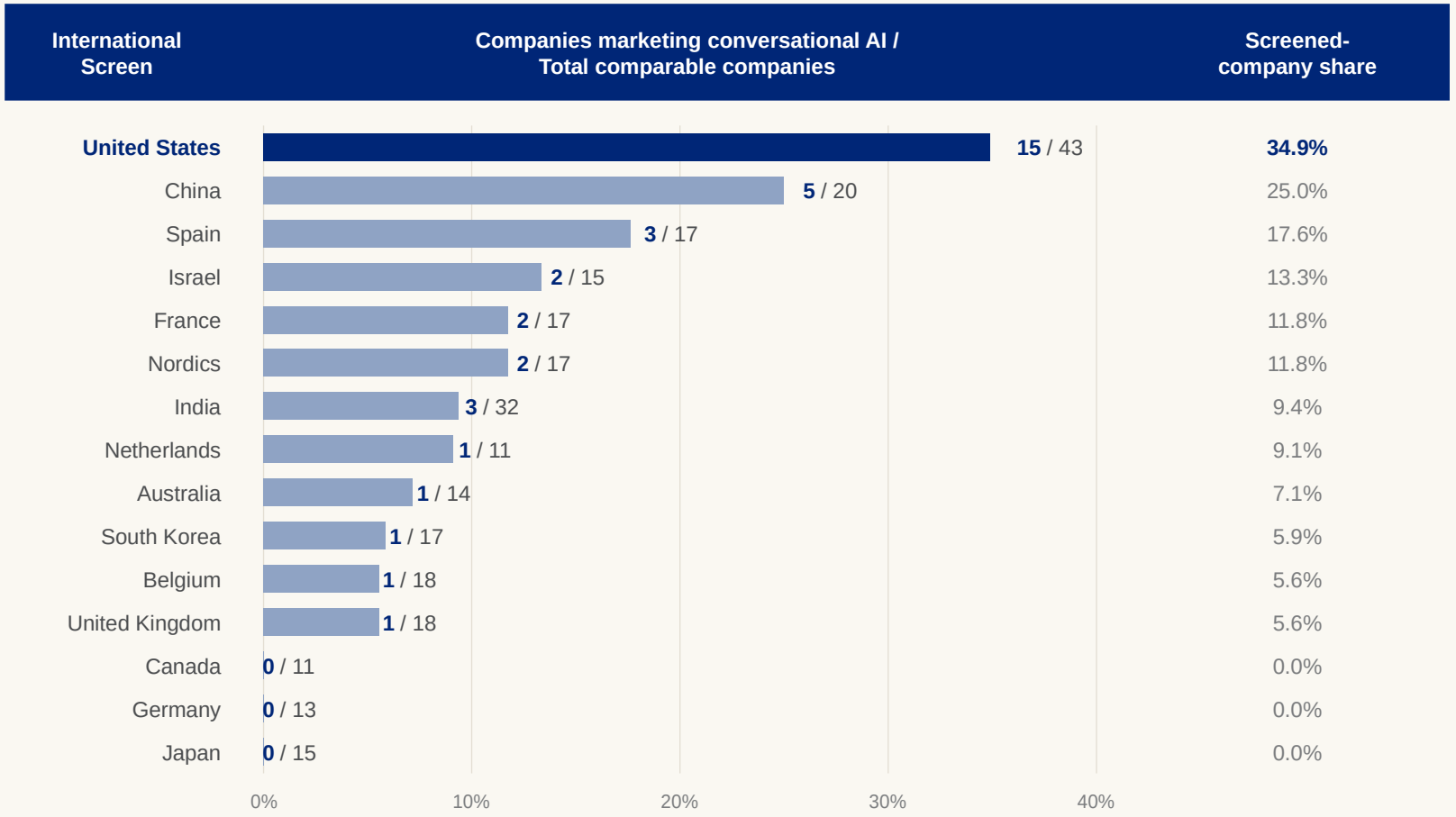
Scope note: Offerings are organized by their primary domain; supporting data and analytics capabilities may serve more than one domain.

KEY TAKEAWAY

A publicly-marketed customer-facing conversational interface was not established in the reviewed materials for Optum LS across the five relevant business domains.

Selected international screens identify additional companies marketing conversational AI across Optum LS-relevant domains

COMPARABLE COMPANIES MARKETING CONVERSATIONAL AI



HOW TO READ THE COMPARISON

Each bar shows the share of comparable companies we screened that market conversational AI. International counts exclude companies already represented in the U.S. inventory.

FROM COMPANY SCREENS TO ACTUAL PRODUCTS

The following slides examine the specific marketed conversational tools and corresponding Optum LS offerings – beginning with RWE.

Competitors are marketing conversational tools to assess healthcare datasets, explore cohorts and answer RWE questions

CUSTOMER TASK	CONVERSATIONAL AI OFFERINGS	RELEVANT OPTUM LS OFFERINGS
Identify and assess suitable data	Truven's **MarketScan Snapshot**: Natural-language assessment of MarketScan data suitability; Norstella's **Ella AI**: Conversational dataset recommendations (along with cohort construction and documented RWE analysis)	**Market Clarity Data** (linked claims/EHR); **Enriched Clinical Data** (NLP-extracted clinical variables)
Explore patient populations and cohorts	Komodo Health's **Marmot** and **MapAI**: conversational healthcare analytics and cohort exploration; Truveta's **Truveta Intelligence**: natural-language research questions over longitudinal clinical data; Briya's **AIRE Population Agent** (Israel): natural-language cohort eligibility and feasibility assessment	**Analytics on Demand** (advanced statistical models); **Clinical Notes Lab** (NLP/LLMs, custom AI models); **Prospector** (no-code cohort building, attrition analysis)
Investigate broader RWE questions	HealthVerity's **eXOs**: Conversational data feasibility, cohort design and auditable RWE analysis; BC Platforms' **BC Catalyst** (Finland): prompt-based cohort building and clinical/genomic research exploration	**Analytics on Demand** (statistical modeling, decision trees); epidemiology research services (advanced study methods, scientific review)

END-TO-END CONVERSATIONAL RWE

HealthVerity's eXOs and Norstella's Ella market conversational access across multiple RWE tasks, from data feasibility or exploration through cohort building and research analytics.

PRE-ENGAGEMENT DATA EVALUATION

Truven also uses their conversational AI as a sales tool, offering qualified prospects free MarketScan Snapshot access to cohort counts and summary statistics before they commit to a full RWE analysis.

Specialty-data platforms bring conversational AI into oncology research and more narrowly-defined evidence questions

CUSTOMER TASK	CONVERSATIONAL AI OFFERINGS	RELEVANT OPTUM LS OFFERINGS
Explore oncology and specialty cohorts	Flatiron Health's **Telescope**: conversational oncology cohort exploration; Tempus's **Lens**: clinical and molecular research exploration	**Enriched Clinical Data** (NLP-derived disease attributes); clinicogenomics datasets (linked clinical/genomic data)
Investigate specialty-disease evidence	ConcertAI's **Precision Explorer**: oncology research analytics; Verana Health's **Agent Claire**: conversational specialty-data research;	**Clinical Notes Lab** (NLP/LLMs, custom AI models); epidemiology and observational research (study design, comparative effectiveness)
Analyze curated research datasets	MDClone's **ADAMS Copilot** (Israel): conversational statistical analysis and visualization within controlled research datasets	**Analytics on Demand** (advanced statistical modeling, survival analysis); research data and study environments (curated data, analytical workspaces)

PACKAGED OUTCOMES STUDIES

ConcertAI markets named Precision Explorer agents for guideline concordance, real-world outcomes and comorbidity analysis; it claims projects can shrink "from 10-20 weeks to as little as 6 weeks."

SELF-SERVICE ANALYSIS

Specialty-data vendors market conversational AI as a way to supplant routine work by analysts: Flatiron's Telescope delivers survival analyses on demand, "eliminating the need to wait in analyst queues," while Verana's Agent Claire offers data access "without needing programming skills or analyst assistance."

Commercial Intelligence AI products extend conversational interaction into market intelligence, field decisions and simulated stakeholder research

CUSTOMER TASK	CONVERSATIONAL AI OFFERINGS	RELEVANT OPTUM LS OFFERINGS
Pharmaceutical market and portfolio intelligence	IQVIA's **GMI Agent**: global market insights; GBI Health's **GBI BOT** (China): pharmaceutical database Q&A and competitive intelligence; Prospection's **ProGPT** (Australia): conversational patient and market insights for brand planning	**Market Clarity** (linked claims/EHR data, market attractiveness and portfolio analytics)
Commercial field and prescribing decisions	IQVIA's **Field Force Agent**: commercial field support; ZS's **ZAIDYN Conversational AI for Commercial**: commercial information and decision support; Close-Up International's **Xplora AI** (Spain): AI-enabled pharmaceutical CRM and commercial intelligence	**Market Clarity** (patient/prescriber segmentation, treatment patterns, market analytics)
Simulated stakeholder research	Trinity Life Sciences' **InsightsEDGE Digital Twins**: conversational simulated personas; Ipsos's **Healthcare PersonaBot** (France): interaction with simulated healthcare stakeholders	**Market Clarity** (observed patient/prescriber insights); no comparable simulated-persona offering established

FROM INSIGHT TO FIELD ACTION

IQVIA's Field Force Agent uses CRM activity and call notes to recommend next best actions, with a claimed prep-time reduction of up to 27%. ZS's commercial assistant generates call plans and draft emails.

SYNTHETIC STAKEHOLDER RESEARCH

Trinity's data-grounded digital twins simulate HCP, patient and payer responses to test messages "without commissioning a new study every time"; Ipsos's PersonaBot hosts a "focus group" of personas drawn from clients' existing research.

Competitors market conversational tools for scientific evidence, medical insights and regulated content workflows

CUSTOMER TASK	CONVERSATIONAL AI OFFERINGS	RELEVANT OPTUM LS OFFERINGS
Search and synthesize scientific evidence	IQVIA's **Med-R1 Deep Research Agent**: synthesizes biomedical, clinical and regulatory sources to answer complex research questions	Epidemiology research (study design, RWE generation); postapproval safety and comparative-effectiveness studies (statistical analysis)
Explore medical insights and support scientific engagement	ZS's **ZAIDYN Conversational AI for Medical**: natural-language analysis of care gaps, scientific insights and opinion-leader information; Evidenze's **AI medical-education chatbots** (Spain): conversational medical education and knowledge support	**Market Clarity** (medical affairs evidence, MSL insights, HCP analytics)
Question and navigate regulated documents	Veeva's **Vault AI Chat**: questions, summaries and follow-up interactions within authorized Vault documents and records	Safety and evidence-research services (scientific analysis); no comparable regulated-document assistant established

TRACKING MEDICAL AFFAIRS IMPACT

ZS positions its medical-affairs analytics as the answer to "what is medical affairs actually achieving?" The suite tracks care gaps in patient-level claims data and compares engaged and non-engaged populations over time; a conversational assistant lets teams query the results.

LIMITS IN THE OPEN

IQVIA says its small Med-R1 research agent can "outperform much larger general-purpose models," while conceding that multi-step biomedical reasoning remains unsolved. In its December 2025 benchmark, Med-R1 answered 21 of 50 questions—and none of the 10 hardest, where OpenAI's and Google's agents managed one between them.

Conversational offerings address specific trial operations and pricing questions, not the entire clinical or market-access workflow

CLINICAL TRIALS — COMPETITIVE EXAMPLES

CUSTOMER TASK	CONVERSATIONAL AI OFFERINGS	RELEVANT OPTUM LS OFFERINGS
Trial feasibility, site and investigator identification	TriNetX's **LIVE Conversational AI + Terrain**: Natural-language protocol feasibility, clinical-code generation and site/investigator intelligence	**Prospector** (no-code cohort building, attrition funnels); **Digital Research Network** (patient identification, recruitment infrastructure)
Clinical-trial document operations	Taimei's **Wiz-iCTA** (China): conversational assistant supporting trial project teams and document-management work	**True Source** (electronic source-data capture); no comparable conversational document assistant established

MARKET ACCESS — COMPETITIVE EXAMPLES

CUSTOMER TASK	CONVERSATIONAL AI OFFERINGS	RELEVANT OPTUM LS OFFERINGS
Pharmaceutical pricing and market-access intelligence	EVERSANA's **Ask NAVLIN**: conversational access to pricing, reimbursement and market-access information	HEOR/value evidence (outcomes research, economic analysis); **Evidence Engine** (evidence-generation support); health economic and budget impact modeling (cost and budget scenarios)

LIVE PROTOCOL TESTING

TriNetX says its LIVE conversational interface turns natural-language eligibility rules into editable clinical codes. In an October 2026 demonstration, adjusting one BMI exclusion criterion shifted a diabetes cohort by 27,000 patients instantly, "with no analyst required." This makes feasibility a live input to protocol design.

ADDITIONAL COMPETITIVE DYNAMIC: LLM PROVIDERS EXPAND INTO LIFE SCIENCES

LLM providers behind conversational AI are expanding into pharmaceutical workflows through partnerships, specialized offerings and acquisitions

THREE OBSERVED APPROACHES TO ENTERING LIFE SCIENCES

LLM PROVIDER APPROACH	SELECTED PUBLIC DEVELOPMENTS	COMPETITIVE SIGNIFICANCE FOR OPTUM LS
Partner with established life-sciences vendors	**Anthropic + Komodo Health:** A documented partnership supporting AI-enabled healthcare analytics; **Anthropic + Veeva:** Claude incorporated into Veeva's industry-specific AI offerings; **AWS + Datavant:** Explore Assistant, publicly described in February 2026, uses Bedrock and AWS Clean Rooms to support natural-language assessment of healthcare datasets and research feasibility.	LLM providers can contribute underlying technology to existing life-sciences platforms while those companies retain specialized data, applications and customer relationships. Komodo and Veeva already appear in our competitive analysis.
Develop their own life-sciences-specific products and tools	**Anthropic's Claude for Life Sciences:** Specialized scientific tools and integrations supporting research, clinical trials and regulatory workflows; **OpenAI's GPT-Rosalind:** A purpose-built model for biology, drug discovery and translational research, with access expanded to eligible organizations in September 2026.	Rather than acting only as technology suppliers, LLM providers are building offerings aimed more directly at life-sciences users. These products are not necessarily direct substitutes for Optum LS's RWE and healthcare-data offerings, but they illustrate potential expansion into adjacent customer workflows.
Acquire specialized life-sciences capabilities	**Cohere + Reliant AI:** In May 2026, Cohere acquired a biopharma AI company offering literature review, competitive landscaping and scientific/regulatory information extraction. The acquisition supports development of North for Pharma, a planned specialized agentic offering.	Acquisitions provide another way for LLM providers to obtain industry-specific technology, expertise and pharmaceutical customer relationships—potentially strengthening their ability to supply or compete with established life-sciences platforms.

STRATEGIC QUESTIONS FOR OPTUM LS

As LLM providers expand beyond supplying general-purpose models, where will they remain technology partners to established life-sciences vendors—and where might they increasingly compete for the same pharmaceutical customers and workflows?

What could these developments mean for the competitive positions of companies whose offerings combine differentiated healthcare data, research tools and scientific expertise?

METHODOLOGY

How this analysis was built

1. SOURCES AND QUALIFICATION

Official vendor product pages and announcements, reviewed through October 13, 2026. Included offerings with publicly marketed conversational interfaces supporting relevant biopharma customer tasks. General AI or agentic capabilities alone did not qualify.

2. U.S. COMPETITOR SCREENING

43 competitor groups screened across five business domains. Identified 15 distinct groups marketing 19 qualifying conversational offerings. Domain-level company counts may overlap.

3. INTERNATIONAL SCREENING

14 selected country/region screens of varying depth, excluding companies already represented in the qualifying U.S. cohort. Nine selected international product examples appear in the analysis. Screened-company percentages are not national adoption rates.

4. COMPARISON AND EVIDENCE LIMITS

Competitor and Optum LS offerings were compared by customer task, not assumed functional equivalence. Findings reflect public positioning rather than independently tested performance or deployment. Named offerings link to supporting public sources. LLM-provider developments are presented separately from the qualifying product counts.